Module - I

Industrial Sociology is the branch of sociology that study social relationships, interaction groups and institutions within industrial and work place.

Nature of Industrial Sociology:

1. Scientific in nature.
2. Applied science.
3. Dynamic in nature.
4. Inter-disciplinary in nature.
5. Analytical.
6. Human-centered.

Scope of Industrial Sociology:

1. Industrial Organisation.
2. Industrial Relation.
3. Work Groups.
4. Labor Problems.

5. Trade Unions.
6. Technology & Industrial Change.
7. Worker's Welfare.
8. Industrial Policies.
9. Industrial Conflict.
10. Productivity & Efficiency.

Importance of Industrial Sociology:

1. Promotes industrial peace.
2. Increases productivity.
3. Improves employee morale.
4. Facilitate collective bargaining.
5. Ensures worker welfare.
6. Helps to resolve conflicts.
7. Promotes social and economical development.

Emile Durkheim

Structural Functionalism

He views society as a complex system whose parts work together to promote solidarity and stability.

He emphasizes that society should be analyzed and described in terms of functions.

Society is a system of interrelated parts where no one can function without each other.

Social Fact

Values, cultural norms and structures that are external to the individual.

Collective Conscience

The shared set of beliefs, ideas and moral attitudes that unify members of a community.

Theory of Social Solidarity

Social Solidarity means social cohesion that binds people together divided into 2 types.

He argued that division of labour in society drives social order, shifting of societies

cohesion from shared similarities to functional inter-dependence.

He explained Theory of Social Solidarity with the help of division of labour in traditional and modern society.

Its two types are; Mechanical Solidarity & Organic.

i. Mechanical Solidarity:

- Based on similarity found in traditional society.
- Division of labour is very less.
- Strong collective conscience.
- Based on repressive law (direct punishment).

ii. Organic Solidarity:

- Based on difference, mutual inter-dependence found in modern society.
- Weak collective conscience.
- Based on restitutive law (legal system).
- High division of labour.
- Rise of individualism and self-interest.

Theory of Suicide

Durkheim proposed that suicide is a social fact i.e. phenomenon shaped more by social conditions than personal pathologies.

He established that variations in suicide rates were directly linked to differences in social integration and regulation. (It is not just an individual act, but also a societal act)

He gave four types of suicide:

1. **Egoistic Suicide:**

   Low integration (detachment or feeling isolated).

2. **Altruistic Suicide:**

   Excessive integration (Sati System / Sacrifice).

3. **Anomic Suicide:**

   Low regulation (joblessness, hopelessness & normlessness).

4. **Fatalistic Suicide:**

   Excessive regulation (oppression).

Imp: # Karl Marx [Father of Socialism, Communism & Marxism]

Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels brought communist manifesto which was a called to working class to rise-up and liberate themselves from perceived change of capatalism. This would be achieved by replacing ~~of~~ own private property with community property.

Dialectic Materialism

Dialectical Materialism states that idea and thoughts of human changes in a dialectical process due to movement and existence of the matter. It is not only a philosophy but also a complete way of thinking to explain the reality.

The key concepts are;

1. Unity of Opposites:
   Every system contains internal contradiction that drive change. For example; struggle between workers and owners.

2. Quantitative to Qualitative:
   Gradual shifts build-up until a system reaches a breaking point.

3. Negation of the Negation:
   Old systems replaced by new ones.

Historical Materialism

Karl Marx's theory ∧ states that human history is driven by material and economic conditions rather than ideas or culture.

Economic Structure

The Base (Infrastructure):

This is the economy, it includes forces of production (tools, technology, human labour, etc) and the relations of production (who owns and control the property.

Super Structure:

This is everything built on top of the economy, includes politics, laws, intelligence, religion, cultural, etc. Marx said that ruling class uses these institutions to protect their wealth and power.

Stages of History:

1. Primitive Communism (Classless Society)
2. Ancient Society (Slaverism) or (Master & Slave)
3. Feudalism (Feudal-lords & serfs)
4. Capatalism (Bourgeoisie & [redacted] Proletariat)
5. Socialism
6. Communism (Utopian) [Imaginary Concept]

Elton Mayo

- Elton Mayo is one of the important thinkers associated with Human Relations.
- His work shifted attention from purely economic & physical factors of production toward social, psychological and human factors at the workplace.
- He conducted an experiment in western electric company, Hawthorne Electrical Works near chicago

Central Idea:

Workers are not merely Economic men motivated by money. They are social human beings whose relationships, group memberships, recognition, participation and feeling influence their behaviour and productivity.

- He focused on; Employee attitudes, Informal groups, Participation, Recognition, Leadership, Communication, Psychological needs, and Social relationships.
- The Hawthorne research initially attempted to understand whether physical working conditions affected productivity.

The study included experiments involving:

1. Illumination
2. Relay Assembly Test Room
3. Interviewing Programme
4. Bank Wiring Observation Room.

1. **Illumination**

Objective: Does the level of lighting affect the worker productivity?

Researchers wanted to establish whether better physical working condition would automatically produce higher productivity.

Method: Workers were divided into experimental and comparision groups.

Result: Results were complicated. Productivity sometimes increased even when illumination was reduced, this suggested that lighting along could not explain changes in productivity. This encouraged further investigation into workers attitudes, social relationships, group behaviour, supervision and attention received by workers.

2. Relay Assembly Test Room

It is one of the most famous stages of Hawthorne Research. Participants were a small group of female workers assembling electrical relays was separated from main production floor and placed in special test-room.

Objective: Researchers wanted to understand how do changes in working condition affect productivity and workers attitudes?

Conditions That Were Changed:

① Working hours.
② Rest pauses.
③ Length of working week.
④ Break arrangements.
⑤ Refreshments.
⑥ Payments or Incentive arrangements.
⑦ Supervision.

Result: Productivity enhanced with special attention.

3. Interviewing Programme

Researchers conducted a very large interview with employees. It eventually involved tens of thousands of interviews.

Objective: Researchers wanted to understand workers feelings, attitudes, complaints, experiences, relationships with supervisors and responses to working condition.

Result: They discovered that workers often have more complicated feelings and this interviewing technique became more open-ended, allowing workers to talk about their experiences. This helped to strengthen human-relations perspective.

4. Bank Wiring Observation Room

This is particularly important from Industrial Sociology perspective because it demonstrates the power of informal group.

Participants: A group of male workers involved in wiring and related production work were been observed.

Result: Workers developed their own informal norms and groups were able to regulate individual behaviour. Therefore, the informal relationships influence actual behaviour more than formal instruction.

Four Principles of Scientific Management:

1. Science, not Rule of Thumb. Instead of allowing workers to used traditional methods, management should study the task scientifically, standardized the methods and identifying unnecessary movements, replacing trial and error method.

2. Scientific selection & training of workers. He argued that workers shouldn't placed randomly into jobs.

3. Cooperation, not Individualism. He wanted management and workers to cooperate rather than remain in constant conflict.

4. Division of work & Responsibility [Harmony not discord]. Proper division of work leads to performing the planned task and meeting the performance standard. This creates harmony and avoid conflicts.

Major Techniques of Scientific Management:

- Time study; determines the time required to complete a task.
- Motion study; identifies and removes unnecessary movements.

- Method study; finds the most efficient method of doing a job.
- Fatigue study; determines proper rest intervals to reduce worker's fatigue.
- Standadization; standardize tools, equipments, methods and working conditions.
- Functional foremenship; divides the supervision amongs specialized foremen.
- Differential piece-rate system; pays higher wages to workers who achieve standard output.

Abraham Maslow

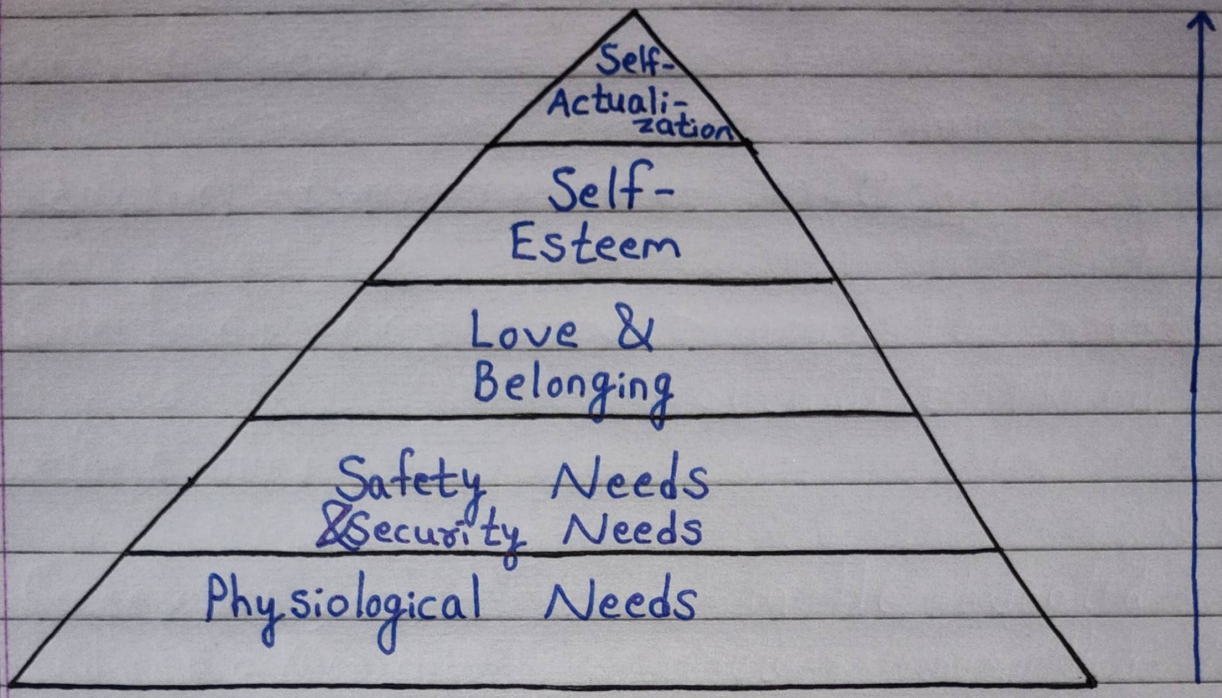


Fig.: Hierarchy of Needs

More Topics Remaining